

MICRO SAVING DAILY

The Wealth Confidence Guide

Simple daily money-awareness shifts
for calmer financial decisions.

Small habits. Stronger money confidence.

Notice. Pause. Repeat.

The Wealth Confidence Guide

Simple daily money-awareness shifts for calmer financial decisions.

Micro Saving Daily — Small habits. Stronger money confidence.

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The method at the heart of this guide is **Notice. Pause. Repeat.**

No specific financial result is promised or guaranteed. Individual circumstances and experiences vary. See the note on the next page before you begin.

Please read this first

Important.

This guide is for educational and informational purposes only. It does not provide financial, investment, tax, legal, medical, or psychological advice. The exercises are meant to support personal awareness and reflection. Individual circumstances and results vary. For guidance specific to your situation, consider speaking with an appropriately qualified professional.

No particular financial result is promised or guaranteed. Micro Saving Daily is an educational brand focused on everyday money awareness.

Welcome

This is not about being perfect with money.

It is about noticing. Most of us already know a lot about our own spending. We just rarely stop to look at it calmly, without pressure or blame.

That is what this guide is for. Over seven short days, you will practice one simple skill: paying gentle attention to a few everyday money choices. You will not track every dollar. You will not build a strict budget. You will not be asked to give anything up.

The goal is quieter and more useful than a budget. It is **confidence** — the sense that you can understand your own choices and adjust them when you want to. Psychologists call this kind of confidence self-efficacy, and it is linked to how much effort people put in and how long they keep going [1].

We use the phrase money confidence on purpose. The Consumer Financial Protection Bureau describes financial well-being as being able to meet your obligations, feel secure, and have the freedom to make choices — and it notes that this looks different for every person [2]. There is no single right way to feel about money.

So there is nothing to fix here. There is only something to notice.

A gentle reminder.

A gentle reminder. You are not behind. You are not doing money “wrong.” You are simply someone who wants a calmer relationship with everyday choices.

How to use this guide

You can read this guide in one sitting, but it works best spread across a week — one short lesson each day.

Each day includes:

- One clear lesson, with a short reason it matters.
- One relatable example.
- One small action to try.
- A **Notice** prompt — a single question to carry with you.
- A reflection question for the end of the day.
- A worksheet with room to write by hand.
- A gentle reminder.

A few suggestions:

- Keep a pen nearby. Writing by hand helps you notice more.
- Do the days in order if you can. Each one builds on the last.
- If you miss a day, simply pick up where you left off. Missing a day is part of the process, not a failure.
- Go at your own pace. There is no prize for finishing quickly.

You do not need any apps, spreadsheets, or special tools. Just this guide, a pen, and a little curiosity.

Notice. Pause. Repeat.

Everything in this guide rests on three small words.

The practice.

Notice — See one everyday money choice clearly, without judging it.

Pause — Give yourself a short, quiet moment before one automatic choice.

Repeat — Carry one small, useful habit into tomorrow.

Here is why these three work well together.

A large share of what we do each day is repeated in familiar settings, often without a fresh decision each time [3]. Many everyday actions are set off automatically by the situations and cues around us — the time of day, the place, the phone in our hand [4]. That is not a flaw. It is how the mind saves energy.

The trouble is that automatic choices are easy to miss. So the first step is simply to **notice** them. This is not busywork. A review of many experiments found that keeping track of your progress toward a goal is linked with a better chance of reaching it [5].

Once you can see a choice, you can **pause** before it. And once a small change feels doable, you can **repeat** it until it becomes part of your day.

That is the whole method. Three words, one week, no pressure.

Day 1 — Notice one spending pattern

Today has one job, and it is a gentle one: notice a single spending pattern. Not all of them. Just one.

Why this matters

A large share of what we do each day is repeated in the same setting, often without a fresh decision each time [3]. Many of these actions are set off automatically by the cues around us — the time of day, a familiar place, the phone in our hand [4]. This is not a weakness. It is how the mind saves effort for bigger things.

The catch is that automatic choices are easy to overlook. That is why the first step is simply to see one of them. And noticing is more powerful than it sounds: a review of many experiments found that keeping track of progress toward a goal is linked with a better chance of reaching it [5].

An everyday example

Think of the afternoon stop for coffee and a snack — same shop, same time, most days. There is nothing wrong with it. But because it happens on autopilot, it is easy to never really look at it. Today, you look. That is all.

What to do today

Pick one purchase you tend to make without much thought. It might be a daily drink, a quick online add-on, a snack at the checkout, or an app you tap out of habit. Watch for it. When it happens, notice it kindly and write a few words.

Notice.

What did I buy today without really deciding to?

Write it down

Worksheet 1 · Notice one spending pattern

Purpose: to see one repeated purchase clearly, without judging it.

How to use it: Pick one purchase you tend to make without much thought. Watch for it today. When it happens (or when you notice the urge), jot down a few words. There are no wrong answers.

Worked example.

The purchase: Afternoon coffee and a snack. **Where / when:** The shop near work, around 3 p.m. **What was going on:** Tired, needed a break, everyone else was going.

Notice	Your notes
The purchase I watched	
Where and when it usually happens	
What was going on around me	
How I felt just before (one or two words)	

Reflection: Where and when does this usually happen?

A gentle reminder.

Noticing is not judging. You are gathering information, not grading yourself.

Before you move on

You do not need to change this purchase. You do not need a plan yet. Today is only about seeing one pattern clearly.

A gentle reminder.

Noticing is not judging. You are simply gathering information about your own day – the way a friend might, with curiosity rather than blame.

Day 2 — Pause before one automatic purchase

Yesterday you noticed a pattern. Today you add one small thing to it: a pause.

Why this matters

Many purchases feel finished before we notice deciding. Research on unplanned buying suggests that situational factors — having time to browse, and how we feel in the moment — often come before the purchase itself [6].

There is also a quieter factor at work. People differ in how much discomfort they feel when spending, sometimes called the “pain of paying.” Research describes how this feeling, and how strongly we feel it, is linked with how much we spend — and people vary widely [7]. A short pause simply gives that natural signal a moment to be heard.

An everyday example

Picture yourself at night, tired, thumb hovering over “Buy now.” The item is in the cart before the day is really reviewed. A ten-second pause does not cancel the purchase. It just opens a small window where a choice can happen.

What to do today

Choose one moment where buying tends to happen fast. Before that purchase today, take about ten quiet seconds. Notice how you feel. Then decide — buy it or not. Either answer is fine.

Notice.

What am I feeling right now — and do I still want this in a minute?

Write it down

Worksheet 2 · The purchase pause

Purpose: to give yourself ten quiet seconds before one automatic purchase.

How to use it: Choose one moment where buying tends to happen quickly. Before that purchase today, take about ten seconds. Breathe. Then fill this in — whether you bought the item or not.

Worked example.

The moment: Adding items to an online cart at night. **During the pause I noticed:** I was tired and a little bored. **What I chose:** Saved it to a list to look at tomorrow.

Pause	Your notes
The moment I chose to pause	
What I noticed during the pause	
Did I still want it after ten seconds?	☐ Yes ☐ Not sure ☐ No
What I chose to do	

Reflection: What happened when I paused?

A gentle reminder.

A pause is not a “no.” Sometimes you will still buy the thing, and that is perfectly fine. The pause just gives the choice back to you.

Before you move on

A pause is a small act of respect for yourself. It is not a rule to obey.

A gentle reminder.

A pause is not a “no.” Sometimes you will still buy the thing – and that is completely fine. The point is that the choice is yours again.

Day 3 — Understand the moment around the purchase

So far you have noticed a pattern and practiced a pause. Today you become a gentle detective. Instead of asking “why did I do that,” you describe what was happening around you.

Why this matters

We often blame willpower for our choices. But habits are set off by the cues in a situation [4], and unplanned purchases tend to follow certain conditions — time to browse, and the mood of the moment [6]. The situation is frequently the real driver, not a lack of discipline.

There is one more thing worth naming kindly. When money feels tight or stressful, that worry can take up mental attention, which may make it harder to focus on other things [8], [9]. This is a general finding about stress and attention, not a statement about you. Naming it simply helps us be gentler with ourselves on hard days.

An everyday example

Boredom, a free evening, and a phone within reach can quietly lead to scrolling a shopping app. No single part is a problem. Together, they form a moment that makes buying easy. Seeing the parts is what gives you options.

What to do today

Pick one recent purchase. Map the moment around it: where you were, the time, who you were with, how you felt, and the cue that set it off. Then notice which part would be easiest to change.

Notice.

What was happening around me just before this purchase?

Write it down

Worksheet 3 · Trigger map

Purpose: to map the situation around one purchase, so you can see what shapes it.

How to use it: Think of one recent purchase. Instead of asking “why did I do that,” describe what was happening around you. The situation is often the real driver.

Worked example.

Place: On the sofa. **Time:** Evening. **With whom:** Alone. **Feeling:** Bored. **Cue:** Phone notification for a sale. **Easiest thing to change:** Keep the phone in another room after dinner.

Part of the moment	Your notes
Where I was (place)	
Time of day	
Who I was with	
How I was feeling	
The cue or trigger (what set it off)	
The part that would be easiest to change	

Reflection: Which part of the situation would be easiest to change?

A gentle reminder.

Triggers are information, not faults. Everyone has them.

Before you move on

You are not looking for something to fix in yourself. You are looking at a situation you can adjust.

A gentle reminder.

Triggers are information, not faults. Everyone has them, and noticing them is a sign of awareness, not a problem.

Day 4 — Choose one small shift

You have noticed, paused, and mapped a moment. Today you turn one observation into a small, specific plan.

Why this matters

Big resolutions often collapse, and vague intentions tend to fade. Research suggests a simple fix: making a specific “when-then” plan — deciding in advance what you will do in a certain situation — is linked with a better chance of following through than a general intention [10]. A meta-analysis across many studies found this kind of planning had a medium-to-large average effect on reaching goals [11].

The key word is specific. “Spend less” is a wish. “When I open the shopping app after dinner, then I’ll add items to a list” is a plan you can actually picture.

An everyday example

A when-then plan might be: “When I feel the urge to buy something at night, then I’ll add it to a list and look again tomorrow.” It is small, clear, and easy to follow. That is exactly what makes it work.

What to do today

Write one when-then shift based on something you noticed this week. Keep it small enough that it feels almost too easy. Small is the point.

Notice.

What is one small, realistic change I could try?

Write it down

Worksheet 4 · One small shift

Purpose: to turn one observation into a specific “when-then” plan.

How to use it: A plan works better when it is specific enough to picture. Fill in the blanks to make one small, realistic shift.

Worked example.

When I open the shopping app after dinner, **then** I will add items to a list and check them tomorrow.

My when-then plan	Your notes
When (the situation or cue)	
Then (the small thing I will do)	
Why this feels doable	
How I will know I did it	

Reflection: Is my plan specific enough to picture in my mind?

A gentle reminder.

Small and doable beats big and abandoned. You can always adjust it later.

Before you move on

You are not trying to change everything. You are choosing one shift, worded so clearly that your future self knows exactly what to do.

A gentle reminder.

Small and doable beats big and abandoned. A plan you actually follow is worth far more than a perfect plan you never start.

Day 5 — Make the easier choice more visible

Today's idea takes pressure off your willpower and puts it on your surroundings instead.

Why this matters

The choice that happens automatically — the “default” — can strongly shape what people end up doing [12]. And because habits are triggered by cues [4], changing the cues and the ease of a choice can quietly change the choice itself. In other words, you do not have to be more disciplined. You can make the calmer option the easy one.

This works in both directions: add a little friction to an automatic purchase, and remove a little friction from the choice you would rather make.

An everyday example

Logging out of stored payment details adds a few seconds to an online purchase — just enough to invite a pause. Moving a shopping app off your home screen means you no longer tap it by reflex. Small changes to your environment do the work that willpower used to.

What to do today

Pick one automatic purchase and make it a little harder. Then pick one calmer choice and make it a little easier. Use the checklist for ideas.

Notice.

What makes this purchase so easy for me right now?

Write it down

Worksheet 5 · Environment and friction checklist

Purpose: to make the calmer choice a little easier and the automatic one a little harder.

How to use it: Check any small changes you are willing to try. You do not need to do all of them — one or two is plenty.

Make the automatic purchase a little harder:

- [?] Log out of stored payment details on one site or app.

- ☐ Remove a saved card from one shopping account.
- ☐ Move a shopping app off my phone's home screen.
- ☐ Turn off sale and “back in stock” notifications for one store.
- ☐ Add one item to a list instead of buying, and check it tomorrow.

Make the calmer choice a little easier:

- ☐ Keep a simple list where I can see it.
- ☐ Put a glass of water or a snack within reach for tired moments.
- ☐ Keep the phone in another room during one part of the day.
- ☐ Decide one “default” ahead of time (for example, coffee at home first).

My own idea	Your notes
One change I want to try	
Where I will set it up	

Reflection: What one change made the calmer choice easier?

A gentle reminder.

You are designing your surroundings, not testing your willpower.

Before you move on

You are arranging your surroundings so the calmer choice needs less effort. That is smart design, not self-control.

A gentle reminder.

You are designing your surroundings, not testing your willpower. Let the setup do the work.

Day 6 — Repeat without expecting perfection

By now you have real tools. Today is about keeping them going through normal, imperfect days.

Why this matters

Here is one of the most freeing findings in this guide. In a real-world study of habit formation, it took about two months on average for a new habit to feel automatic — and the range was very wide, from about three weeks to many months [13]. There is no magic number, despite what you may have heard.

Even better: in that same study, missing a single day did not stop the habit from forming [13]. One skipped day is not a broken streak. It is just a day.

And when a slip does happen, how you respond matters. Responding with kindness rather than harsh self-criticism is linked with more motivation to try again [14]. Being gentle with yourself is not soft. It is practical.

An everyday example

Imagine a busy week where you skip the practice for a day or two. The old story says, “I failed, so why bother.” The kinder and more accurate story says, “That was a full week. I’ll pick it up again tomorrow.” The second story is the one that keeps habits alive.

What to do today

Track your practice lightly — just “yes” or “not yet.” Then plan for a day that might be hard, so a likely miss does not surprise you.

Notice.

Did I practice today — yes, or not yet?

Write it down

Worksheet 6 · Repetition tracker

Purpose: to keep the practice going lightly, without expecting perfection.

How to use it: Each day, simply mark whether you practiced. “Not yet” is a fine answer. There is no streak to protect and nothing to lose by missing a day.

Day	Practiced?	One word about today
Day 1	☐ Yes ☐ Not yet	
Day 2	☐ Yes ☐ Not yet	
Day 3	☐ Yes ☐ Not yet	
Day 4	☐ Yes ☐ Not yet	
Day 5	☐ Yes ☐ Not yet	
Day 6	☐ Yes ☐ Not yet	
Day 7	☐ Yes ☐ Not yet	

My plan for a likely miss:

Your notes
A day that might be hard this week
What I will do to come back

Reflection: What helped me come back after a miss?

A gentle reminder.

In one real-world study, missing a single day did not stop a habit from forming [13]. One miss is just one day.

Before you move on

Repetition, not perfection, is what builds a habit. You are allowed to miss and return as many times as you need.

A gentle reminder.

Missing a day is part of the process, not the end of it. Begin again whenever you are ready.

Day 7 — Build your personal awareness plan

You have practiced all three parts of the method: Notice, Pause, Repeat. Today you gather the week into one simple plan that belongs to you.

Why this matters

Insights fade without a little structure. A when-then plan helps carry an intention into action [11], and pulling your best ideas onto one page makes them easy to return to.

There is also a deeper reason. As your confidence grows — your sense that you can understand and adjust your own choices — you are building what psychologists call self-efficacy, which is linked with how much effort people invest and how long they persist [1]. This week was never really about one coffee or one cart. It was about that quiet, steady confidence.

An everyday example

A finished plan might read: “I’m watching my evening phone-shopping pattern. When the urge shows up, I pause and add items to a list. I moved the app off my home screen. On hard days, I’ll just reread this page.” Simple, personal, repeatable.

What to do today

Complete your one-page awareness plan. Keep it somewhere you will see it.

Notice.

Which one habit from this week is most worth keeping?

Write it down

Worksheet 7 · My personal awareness plan

Purpose: to combine the week into one simple, repeatable plan that is yours.

How to use it: Look back at your notes from the week. Pull the most useful pieces into one page you can return to.

My plan	Your notes
One pattern I want to keep noticing	

My plan	Your notes
One moment where I will pause	
My one small “when-then” shift	
One change I made to my surroundings	
What I will do on a hard day	
One reason this matters to me	

Reflection: Which one habit is most worth keeping?

A gentle reminder.

This is your plan, not a test. Adjust it freely as life changes.

Before you move on

This plan is a living thing. Change it whenever your life changes. That is not failing to follow it — that is using it well.

A gentle reminder.

This is your plan, built from your own week. There is no single right version — only the one that helps you feel a little calmer about money.

Seven-day reflection

You reached the end of the week. That is worth pausing on.

You did not overhaul your finances, and you were never meant to. You practiced something quieter and more lasting: paying gentle attention to a few everyday choices. Looking back is part of the practice. Keeping track of progress toward a goal is linked with a better chance of reaching it [5], so take a few minutes to notice how the week went.

Worksheet 8 · Seven-day reflection

Purpose: to look back gently and notice what you learned.

How to use it: There are no grades here. Write a few honest words for each line. Looking back is part of the practice — keeping track of progress is linked with a better chance of reaching a goal [5].

Looking back	Your notes
The most useful thing I noticed	
A moment I felt calmer about a choice	
Something that surprised me	
One thing I want to keep doing	
One thing I want to let go of	

A gentle reminder.

Progress is not a straight line. A week of gentle noticing is real progress.

Common moments that may influence spending

The seven days gave you a method. These next pages offer gentle notes on a few everyday situations where the method is especially handy. Read the ones that fit your life and skip the rest.

Certain moments tend to make spending easier. Research on unplanned buying points to having time to browse and to the mood of the moment as common conditions around a purchase [6]. People also differ in how much discomfort they feel when spending, which is linked with how much they spend [7]. And on days when money feels stressful, that worry can occupy attention, which may make it harder to focus on other things [8].

None of these are faults. They are simply moments to meet with a little more awareness:

- **Tiredness.** Late-night choices often feel different in the morning.
- **Boredom.** A free moment plus a phone can turn into browsing.
- **Stress.** A purchase can feel like quick relief.
- **Celebration.** Good news can loosen the pause.
- **Routine.** The same place at the same time invites the same purchase [4].

For any of these, the method is the same: notice the moment, pause for ten seconds, and — if it helps — plan one small shift.

Recurring purchases and automatic renewals

Some spending happens without any moment of choice at all, because we agreed to it once and it now repeats on its own.

Automatic renewals are a good example. A consumer guide from the Federal Trade Commission explains that many subscriptions renew automatically unless you cancel, and it suggests knowing the terms and how to cancel before you sign up — and watching for boxes that are already checked for you [15].

These arrangements can quietly add up. In one study of gym memberships, many people chose monthly plans but visited so rarely that they paid much more than they would have by paying per visit — and some kept paying for a while after they

had stopped going [16]. This is not about being careless. It is about how easy it is to forget something that renews silently in the background.

A gentle once-a-season review can help:

- List the subscriptions and memberships you can remember.
- For each, ask: Did I use this the way I expected?
- Note how to cancel or pause the ones you are unsure about.
- There is no need to cancel anything today. Awareness comes first.

Online shopping and convenience spending

Shopping online is designed to be smooth. That is helpful when you know what you want, and easy to drift into when you do not.

Research on online shopping suggests the design and feel of a store's website can relate to unplanned buying [17]. Saved cards, one-tap checkout, and "recommended for you" rows all remove the small pauses that once came with a trip to a store. And because habits are triggered by cues [4], the app icon itself can be the nudge that starts a purchase.

A few calm adjustments, drawn from Day 5:

- Keep a running list and buy from the list, not from the feed.
- Log out of stored payment on one site, so checkout takes a few seconds longer.
- Turn off sale and "back in stock" alerts for one store.
- Let items sit in the cart overnight when you are unsure.

None of this means never shopping online. It means adding back a small pause the convenience removed.

Family, household, and gift-related spending

Some of the most meaningful spending is not really about us. It is about the people we care for — children, parents, grandchildren, partners, and friends.

These purchases can also be the most automatic, because they are wrapped in love and routine [3]. A standing weekly treat, a habit of always covering the bill, or a gift chosen quickly under time pressure can all run on autopilot.

The goal here is not to spend less on the people you love. It is only to bring the same gentle awareness you practiced this week:

- Notice which family or gift purchases happen automatically.
- Pause on one of them — not to stop it, but to make sure it still fits what you value.
- Where it helps, plan ahead, so a purchase reflects care rather than time pressure.

Spending on others can be one of the most rewarding parts of money. Awareness simply helps it stay intentional.

What to do when the habit disappears

At some point, the practice will slip. A busy stretch, a trip, an illness, or simply life will get in the way, and one day you will realize you stopped noticing. This is normal. It happens to everyone.

It helps to remember how habits actually form. In a real-world study, reaching the point where a behavior felt automatic took about two months on average, with a wide range from person to person — and missing a single day did not stop the habit from forming [13]. A habit is not a fragile streak that shatters the moment you miss. It is more like a path you can step back onto.

So if the habit disappears, nothing is lost. The awareness you built is still there. You simply return to it.

A compassionate restart plan

The way you talk to yourself after a break matters. Responding with kindness rather than harsh self-criticism is linked with more motivation to try again [14], and self-compassion is associated with lower stress when we fall short of what we intended [18]. In other words, being gentle with yourself is not an excuse — it is what actually helps you begin again.

A restart does not need to be big. The smallest step counts: reread your one when-then plan, or simply notice one purchase tomorrow. Fill in your restart plan now, while things are calm, so it is ready when you need it.

Worksheet 9 · A compassionate restart plan

Purpose: to make coming back easy after a break, without self-criticism.

How to use it: Fill this in now, while things are calm. Then it is ready for the day you need it.

Worked example.

My kind first step: Reread my one “when-then” plan and try it once. **What I will tell myself:** “One missed week is just one week. I can begin again today.”

My restart plan	Your notes
The smallest first step I can take	
A kind sentence to say to myself	
When I will begin again	

Reflection: What is the gentlest way I can begin again?

A gentle reminder.

Responding to a slip with self-kindness, rather than harsh criticism, is linked with more motivation to try again [14] and with lower stress [18]. Being kind to yourself is practical, not soft.

Your next 30 days

You do not need another seven-day program. You need a calm, realistic pace for carrying one small habit forward.

Habits form over time, and the pace varies a lot from person to person [13]. So think of the next month not as a countdown, but as a gentle map. A simple when-then plan will help you keep going [11]. Choose one habit worth keeping, and let it settle into your days.

Worksheet 10 · Your next 30 days

Purpose: to carry one small habit forward at a calm, realistic pace.

How to use it: Habits form over time, and the pace varies a lot from person to person [13]. This is not a countdown. It is a gentle map for the next few weeks. Choose one habit to keep practicing.

The habit I am keeping

Weeks 1–2

Your notes

The one habit I will practice

When and where it fits my day

Weeks 3–4

Your notes

What I will keep the same

One small thing I might add

How I will handle a hard day

A gentle check-in question for each week: Did this make one choice a little calmer?

A gentle reminder.

There is no finish line and no perfect score. Slow and steady counts. If you miss days, you simply begin again.

Resources and personal notes

Keep going with what you built. The most useful resource is already in your hands: your own awareness plan and your next-30-days map. Return to them often.

Free, reputable information. If you want to learn more, look for information from public, non-commercial sources. For example, the Consumer Financial Protection Bureau offers free educational material and describes financial well-being as being able to meet your obligations, feel secure, and have the freedom to make choices [2]. Be cautious with any resource that promises guaranteed results.

Stay connected. You can return to Micro Saving Daily at microsavingdaily.com and keep an eye on your email for future educational resources.

Personal notes

Use this space for any thoughts, reminders, or small wins from the week.

References

The ideas in this guide are informed by the research and public resources listed below. These sources describe general patterns and tendencies; they do not promise any particular result for any individual. Where research is mentioned in the text, the wording is kept careful on purpose — real studies describe what may be true for many people, not what is guaranteed for everyone.

One last thing

You gave a week of gentle attention to something most people rush past. That is not a small thing.

Remember what this guide was really about. Not a coffee. Not a cart. It was about confidence — the quiet sense that you can understand your own choices and adjust them when you want to. That kind of confidence tends to grow the more you use it, influencing how much effort we put in and how long we keep going [1].

So keep it simple from here:

- **Notice** one thing at a time.
- **Pause** when you can.
- **Repeat** what helps, and begin again whenever you drift.

There is no finish line, and there is nothing to be perfect about. There is only the next small, calm choice — and you already know how to meet it.

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